11. Pötzl . p.65

12. Ibid

13. From My Life . p.193

14. Honecker Cross Examined . p.109

15. By the mid-1960s, the Stasi was employing 50,000 full-time staff and had over 100,000 collaborators.

Return To Moscow

1. From this point, Karl Schirdewan, gained influence within the FDJ given his position as the youth secretary in the Central Committee. Schirdewan had long considered Honecker an ineffective windbag, ill-suited to his job. Also, it is worth noting, that with Honecker in Moscow, Albert Norden detailed criticism culminates in the demand that FDJ work must be ‘turned inside out’, the ‘structure of the apparatus to be changed’. Norden’s working group had carried out thorough research in several towns and rural communities in order to obtain an authentic picture of the state of the FDJ.

2. Remarkably, the four-man delegation from East Germany – Walter Ulbricht, Otto Grotewohl, Alfred Neumann and Karl Schirdewan – had not been invited to hear Khrushchev, so after dinner, they retired to bed. It was only when a Soviet comrade woke them up at 3 am that same morning that they learned about Khrushchev’s outburst. He spoke of how within a few short hours, the man who had ruled supreme for three decades had been unmasked as a despot. After listening intently, the German delegation returned to their beds, without a single word or comment; only Schirdewan stayed up to write a detailed note of the speech. ‘Walter Ulbricht and Karl Schirdewan, who stayed in Moscow, said nothing to me about,’ Honecker lashed out acidly.